> The Tuticorin company being our first great industrial effort, if we let it fail, the world will never ever believe us. People everywhere will pour scorn on us. We may even lose confidence in ourselves. Every reader of this appeal, much like its author, should, this very moment, remit whatever is at hand—even half a paisa …[118]

A week later, Bharati was writing that ‘the minor troubles’ plaguing the company were being resolved. The *Gallia* was out of deep waters, he claimed. Bharati was not beyond giving false hopes to his readers; or was he deluding himself? But still, he said, people should not become complacent; they should treat this like their own family’s crisis. Charity had to be prompt. Doing the right thing should brook no delay. Bharati urged others to emulate Ramaiyer, ‘a poor mirasdar’ as he called himself, from Melaiyur village of Thiruvidaimaruthur in Thanjavur district, who had remitted Rs 10.[119]

The following issue of *India* carried a cartoon (Figure 19). With a steamer on the seas in the background, Bharata Mata is seen exhorting the public: ‘It is my will that [the Swadeshi shipping venture] should succeed … May it flourish!’ Four men, representing the Indian people, are seconding her exhortation with the word, ‘*Tathasthu!*’[120] Whether ‘So be it!’ got translated into action is a different question.